Statement of the Problem

Employee performance is a key factor in determining organizational effectiveness, particularly in public sector institutions that are responsible for service delivery and infrastructure development. The Osun State Ministry of Works plays a critical role in planning, constructing, and maintaining public infrastructure, and the ministry's success is highly dependent on the competence, motivation, and efficiency of its workforce. In recent years, the ministry has faced a range of human resource management challenges that have negatively affected employee performance and overall productivity.

One major challenge has been the inefficiency of recruitment and selection processes, which sometimes results in employees being assigned to roles that do not fully match their technical skills or professional expertise. This mismatch has contributed to delays, operational inefficiencies, and occasional substandard project outputs. Additionally, training and development opportunities for staff have been limited, restricting skill enhancement, professional growth, and the ability to adapt to emerging technological and operational demands. Performance appraisal systems have also proven to be inconsistent and are often perceived as not fully reflective of employees' actual contributions. This has frequently led to low motivation, reduced commitment, and a decline in overall productivity.

Compounding these issues, compensation and reward mechanisms have been inadequate, failing to sufficiently motivate employees or recognize exceptional performance. Furthermore, limited employee participation in decision-making processes has reduced engagement, creativity, and a sense of ownership over projects, making it difficult for employees to take initiative or contribute meaningfully to organizational objectives. Collectively, these human resource management challenges have hindered employee performance, affected project execution, and weakened service delivery within the ministry.

Although formal HRM policies exist, gaps in their practical implementation have prevented the ministry from fully realizing the potential of its workforce. Therefore, this study seeks to investigate the effect of human resource management practices on employee performance in the Osun State Ministry of Works. By examining the influence of recruitment and selection, training and development, performance appraisal, compensation and reward systems, and employee participation on employee performance, the study aims to provide insights that can strengthen HRM strategies, enhance workforce productivity, and improve service delivery outcomes in the ministry.